

Word family: **pace / paces / paced / pacing / pacer / pacy / paced**

Base word: pace

Forms: paces, paced, pacing

Related forms: pacer, pacy/pacey

Common compounds: fast-paced, slow-paced, well-paced

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “...whenever I need peace, perspective, or simply a break from the **pace** of daily life.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **pace** means the **speed or rate at which daily life proceeds**.

It refers to how quickly activities, responsibilities, work, communication, and everyday demands seem to move.

繁體中文： **節奏；步調；事情進行的速度**

中文翻譯：

> “...a break from the **pace of daily life**.”

「.....暫時逃離日常生活的**節奏 / 步調**。」

Here:

the pace of daily life = 日常生活運轉、活動和壓力推進的速度與節奏

1. **pace = speed/rate of movement or activity (速度 / 步調) — 速度；步調；節奏**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: The speed at which someone or something moves, works, develops, or happens.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Sometimes I need a break from the **pace** of daily life.”

「有時我需要暫時逃離日常生活的**快節奏 / 步調**。」

Practice 2

> “The project is moving at a very fast **pace**.”

「這個項目正以非常快的**速度 / 步調**推進。」

Practice 3

> “I prefer to work at my own **pace**.”

「我比較喜歡按照自己的**步調**工作。」

pace = 人、活動、工作、生活或事件向前推進的速度

Common:

- * fast pace
- * slow pace
- * steady pace
- * pace of life
- * pace of change
- * at your own pace

This is the broad central meaning.

2. **pace** = speed of walking/running (移動速度) — 步速 ; 跑速

Pace often specifically refers to how quickly someone walks or runs.

Practice 4

> “She walked at a brisk **pace**.”

「她以輕快的**步速**走路。」

Practice 5

> “He increased his **pace** near the finish.”

「接近終點時，他加快了**速度**。」

pace = 行走或跑步時的速度

For strict semantic counting, this belongs under Meaning 1, but it is a highly common physical subtype.

3. **pace** = rate of progress/development (進度) — 進展速度；發展步伐

Pace can describe how quickly change, development, learning, or work proceeds.

Practice 6

> “The **pace** of technological change is difficult to follow.”

「科技變化的**速度**很難跟上。」

Practice 7

> “The reforms continued at a slower **pace**.”

「改革以較慢的**步伐**繼續。」

pace = 某個過程、發展或改變進行的快慢

Again, this belongs under the general speed/rate branch.

4. **a pace** = one step / stride (一步) — 一步；步幅

Pace can mean a single step taken while walking.

Practice 8

> “He took a few **paces** toward the door.”

「他朝門口走了幾**步**。」

Practice 9

> “She stood ten **paces** away.”

「她站在大約十**步**之外。」

a pace = 行走時的一步，亦可粗略用來表示距離

This is a genuinely distinct noun sense from “speed.”

5. **pace** = length of one step (步幅 / 步距) — 步幅 ; 一步的距離

Historically and in measurement contexts, a **pace** can also mean the distance covered by a step.

Practice 10

> “The tree was about twenty **paces** from the house.”

「那棵樹距離房子大約二十**步**。」

This is closely tied to Meaning 4 and should usually be merged with it.

6. **pace** = manner/rhythm of a story, film, speech, etc. (敘事節奏) — 節奏 ; 推進速度

Books, films, speeches, lessons, and performances can have a **pace**.

Practice 11

> “The film has a fast **pace**.”

「這部電影的**節奏**很快。」

Practice 12

> “The story loses **pace** in the middle.”

「故事到了中段 , **節奏**慢了下來。」

pace = 內容、情節或表演向前推進的快慢和節奏

This develops from the general rate/speed sense, but it is an important media/writing application.

7. **pace** = specific gait of a horse (馬術) — 側對步 ; 特定步法

In horse terminology, **pace** can refer to a particular gait in which the legs on the same side move together.

Practice 13

> “The horse moved into a **pace**.”

「那匹馬開始以**側對步**行進。」

This is a genuine specialist sense.

For general learners, it is lower priority.

8. **pace = walk back and forth repeatedly (動詞) — 踱步 ; 來回走**

As a verb, **pace** often means to walk repeatedly back and forth, especially because of nervousness, impatience, or thought.

Practice 14

> “He **paced** the room while waiting for the call.”

「他等電話時在房間裡不停**踱步**。」

Practice 15

> “She was **pacing** up and down outside.”

「她在外面不停地**來回踱步**。」

pace = 在一個有限範圍內反覆來回行走

This is a major distinct verb sense.

9. **pace = regulate the speed of someone/something (動詞) — 控制節奏 ; 掌握速度**

Pace can mean controlling the rate at which an activity, race, performance, or process develops.

Practice 16

> “She **paced** the race perfectly.”

「她非常準確地**控制了比賽節奏**。」

Practice 17

> “The teacher **paced** the lesson carefully.”

「老師仔細地**掌握課堂節奏**。」

pace something = 控制某件事進行的速度，使其不過快或過慢

This is a major transitive verb branch.

10. **pace yourself = control your effort so you do not tire too quickly (固定用法) — 控制節奏；量力而為**

Practice 18

> “You need to **pace yourself** during a long exam.”

「長時間考試期間，你需要**控制自己的節奏**。」

Practice 19

> “Don’t work too hard at the beginning—**pace yourself**.”

「一開始別太拼命，**要分配好體力 / 掌握節奏**。」

pace yourself = 控制自己的速度、體力或工作量，避免過早疲累

This is one of the most useful constructions with **pace**.

11. **pace someone = help set another person's speed (領跑 / 配速) — 為……配速；帶領速度**

In running and other endurance activities:

Practice 20

> “A friend **paced** him through the final ten kilometres.”

「朋友在最後十公里替他**配速 / 帶跑**。」

pace someone = 以某個穩定速度帶領對方，幫助其維持目標速度

This belongs to the regulate-speed verb branch.

12. **pace out / pace off = measure by walking steps (片語) — 用步數量距離**

Practice 21

> “He **paced out** the length of the room.”

「他用步數**量出**房間的長度。」

Practice 22

> “She **paced off** twenty metres.”

「她用步伐**估量出**大約二十米。」

This is a phrasal construction built from **pace = step**.

Useful expression: **keep pace with = 跟上.....的速度 / 進展**

Practice 23

> “Businesses must keep **pace with** technological change.”

「企業必須**跟上**科技變化的步伐。」

Practice 24

> “I struggled to keep **pace with** the group.”

「我很難**跟上**這群人的速度。」

****keep pace with = 保持與某人 / 某事相同的速度或發展進度****

It can be literal or figurative.

Useful expression: **set the pace = 定下速度 / 帶頭**

Practice 25

> “The fastest runner **set the pace**.”

「最快的跑手**定下了比賽速度**。」

Practice 26

> “The company has **set the pace** for innovation.”

「這家公司在創新方面**帶頭 / 樹立了發展速度**。」

set the pace = 決定其他人要跟隨的速度、標準或發展程度

This has both literal and figurative uses.

Useful expression: **change of pace** = 節奏上的變化；換換口味

Practice 27

> “Working outdoors was a nice **change of pace**.”

「在戶外工作讓人有種很好的**節奏轉換 / 換換環境的感覺**。」

a change of pace = 與平常不同的活動或生活節奏，令人覺得有變化

Useful expression: **at a snail's pace** = 慢吞吞地；極慢

Practice 28

> “Traffic was moving at a snail's **pace**.”

「交通以**蝸牛般的速度 / 極慢的速度**移動。」

This is a fixed metaphorical expression under the speed sense.

Useful expression: **put someone/something through their/its paces** = 全面測試

This is an important idiom.

Practice 29

> “The reviewers put the new car through its **paces**.”

「評測人員對新車進行了**全面測試**。」

Practice 30

> “The coach put the players through their **paces**.”

「教練讓球員完成一系列訓練，以**測試他們的能力**。」

put someone/something through their/its paces = 讓某人 / 某物完成一系列任務，以測試其能力或性能

Historically this relates to making a horse demonstrate its different gaits.

Related form: **pacemaker**

A **pacemaker** can mean:

1. a person/animal that sets or maintains a pace;
2. a horse trained to move in the pacing gait;
3. in sport, someone who helps another athlete maintain a target speed.

Practice 31

> “The runner used a **pacemaker** to maintain his target speed.”

「那名跑手利用**配速員**維持目標速度。」

Related form: **pace / pacy**

Pacy or **pacey** can mean moving quickly or having a fast, lively pace.

Practice 32

> “It is a **pacy** thriller.”

「這是一部**節奏明快**的驚悚作品。」

Practice 33

> “He is a **pacey** winger.”

「他是一名**速度很快**的翼鋒。」

Both spellings occur; **pace** is common in British English.

Related compounds: **fast-paced** / **slow-paced** / **well-paced**

fast-paced

> “She works in a fast-paced environment.”

「她在一個**節奏很快**的工作環境中工作。」

slow-paced

> “He prefers a slow-paced lifestyle.”

「他喜歡**步調較慢**的生活方式。」

well-paced

> “The film is well-paced.”

「這部電影的**節奏掌握得很好**。」

These are highly useful family extensions.

Specialist use: **pace** = with due respect to / contrary to the opinion of (拉丁借詞)

There is also a completely separate scholarly use of **pace**, borrowed directly from Latin.

It is typically used before a person's name to mean roughly:

> **with due respect to X, contrary to X's view**

Example:

> “Pace Smith, the evidence suggests otherwise.”

≈ 「**恕我不同意 Smith 的看法**，證據似乎顯示情況並非如此。」

This is pronounced differently from ordinary English **pace** and appears mainly in academic, legal, or scholarly writing.

It is genuine, but **very low priority** for general learners and should not be included in the

everyday core count.

Important distinction: **pace vs speed**

speed

is the broadest word for how fast something moves.

pace

often emphasizes:

- * sustained rate
- * rhythm
- * progress over time

> driving speed

> pace of work

For human movement, both can overlap.

Important distinction: **pace vs rate**

rate

is more abstract and measurable.

pace

is often more experiential and dynamic.

> rate of inflation

> pace of change

Both can describe change, but **pace** evokes how quickly the process is unfolding.

Important distinction: **pace vs rhythm**

rhythm

emphasizes recurring pattern or beat.

pace

emphasizes speed of progression.

A story can have:

- > good rhythm
- > fast pace

Related, but not identical.

Important distinction: **pace vs tempo**

tempo

originally belongs strongly to music and means speed of a musical passage.

It can also be figurative.

pace

is broader and common for life, work, stories, walking, change, etc.

- > musical tempo
- > pace of life

Important distinction: **pace vs step**

step

usually means the action of moving one foot.

pace

can mean a whole stride/step used as a unit of distance.

- > take a step
- > stand ten paces away

Important distinction: **pace vs walk**

walk

means move on foot.

pace

as a verb often means walk repeatedly back and forth.

> walk to the station

> pace the room

Very different implication.

Grammar note: **pace** can be noun or verb

Noun

> “The pace is too fast.”

Verb — intransitive

> “He paced nervously.”

Verb — transitive

> “She paced the race carefully.”

This verb flexibility is important.

Countability note

Pace changes countability by sense.

Usually singular/uncountable-like rate

> at a fast pace

> pace of life

Countable step

- > one pace
- > several paces

Countable horse gait in specialist contexts

- > a pace

So grammar depends heavily on meaning.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * **pace**
- * **paces**
- * **paced**
- * **pacing**
- * **pacer**
- * **pacy / pacy**

Very useful compounds:

- * **fast-paced**
- * **slow-paced**
- * **well-paced**

Important constructions:

- * at your own pace
- * pace yourself
- * keep pace with
- * set the pace
- * change of pace
- * put through one's paces
- * pace out / pace off

The core semantic network is built mostly around two images:

1. **speed/rate of progression**
2. **steps/walking**

Most figurative uses develop from those rather than representing unrelated dictionary senses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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pace — speed/rate	人、活動、生活、工作或過程向前推進的速度 / 步調
pace — walking/running speed	行走或跑步的速度
pace — story/activity rhythm	故事、電影、課堂等推進的節奏
a pace — step	行走時的一步 / 一步的距離
pace — horse gait	馬的一種特定側對步步法；專門
pace — verb, walk repeatedly	在某處來回踱步
pace — verb, regulate speed	控制活動、比賽或表演進行的速度
pace yourself	控制自己的速度、體力或工作量，避免過早疲累
keep pace with	跟上某人的速度或某事的發展進度
set the pace	定下其他人跟隨的速度或標準
change of pace	改變平常節奏；換換活動 / 環境
put through one's paces	透過一系列任務全面測試能力或性能
pacemaker	配速員；亦可指特定步態的馬
pace / pacy	快速的；節奏明快的
pace — Latin scholarly use	「恕我不同意 / 儘管某人的看法」；罕見專門用法

For your original sentence

> "...a break from the **pace** of daily life."

The exact meaning is:

pace = 日常生活中工作、責任、活動和各種事情不斷向前推進的速度與節奏

So:

> **the pace of daily life**

= **日常生活的步調 / 節奏**

In this passage, it carries the idea that ordinary city life can move so quickly that the library provides temporary relief from that speed.

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **pace**:

- speed/rate at which movement, activity, life, or a process proceeds**
- a single step / stride used as movement or rough distance**
- verb — walk repeatedly back and forth**
- verb — regulate/set the rate of an activity or person**

I would merge narrative pace, pace of change, running pace, and pace of life into #1; keep the horse gait as a lower-priority specialist extension; and keep **pace yourself**, **keep pace with**, **set**

the pace, change of pace, put through one's paces** as important fixed constructions rather than inflating the core count.